

Bedrock-Enriched SOAR Report

Lab G - Unused Authentication Token Detector

Detector Summary

Generated: 2026-07-31 22:13:25 UTC

Finding count: 1

AI enrichments succeeded: 1

AI enrichments failed: 0

AI status: SUCCESS

Model: us.anthropic.claude-sonnet-4-6

Stop reason: end_turn

Alert type: UNUSED_TOKEN

Username: test-user-1

Token age: 33 minutes

Threshold: 10 minutes

AI Incident Analysis

Unused Authentication Token Analysis

1. Severity

Severity: Low-Medium (Informational with follow-up required)

- Token is 33 minutes old, exceeding the 10-minute alert threshold by 23 minutes
 - No confirmed malicious activity; the token was issued but never consumed
 - Username test-user-1 suggests a non-production or service account, which may carry elevated risk if misconfigured
 - Insufficient corroborating evidence to escalate beyond low-medium at this time
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2. Plausible Benign Explanations

- **Abandoned workflow:** A developer or automated process requested a token but the downstream step failed, timed out, or was cancelled before use
- **Test account activity:** test-user-1 may be part of a CI/CD pipeline or QA process where token generation is routine and consumption is intermittent
- **User error:** A human operator generated a token manually (e.g., via a portal or CLI) and forgot to use it or used a different token instead

- **Clock/sync issue:** A client-side timing mismatch caused the consuming service to treat the token as expired before attempting use
 - **Staged deployment:** Token was pre-generated for a deployment that has not yet reached the consumption phase
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3. Plausible Suspicious Explanations

- **Credential harvesting probe:** An attacker with partial access generated a token to test authentication endpoints without completing a full login, avoiding deeper audit trails
- **Reconnaissance activity:** Token generation without use may indicate an adversary mapping the authentication system's behavior or rate limits
- **Compromised automation account:** If test-user-1 credentials were stolen, an attacker may have triggered token issuance but been interrupted or deterred before use
- **Token exfiltration attempt:** Token was generated and exfiltrated for later use outside the monitored environment; the "unused" status may be temporary
- **Misconfigured or rogue script:** An unauthorized script running under this account is generating tokens without a legitimate consuming process

*WARNING **Uncertainty note:** None of these suspicious scenarios are confirmed. Corroborating signals (failed logins, lateral movement, anomalous IPs) are absent from the provided telemetry.*

4. Prioritized Analyst Actions

1. **Check originating IP and user-agent** for the token issuance request - determine if it matches known systems or locations for test-user-1
 2. **Review recent authentication history** for test-user-1: look for failed logins, unusual hours, or access from new geolocations
 3. **Determine account type and ownership** - confirm whether test-user-1 is a service account, shared account, or individual user, and identify the responsible owner
 4. **Search for related token activity** - query for other tokens issued by this account in the past 24-48 hours to identify patterns
 5. **Check if the token is still valid** - if so, assess whether it should be revoked based on business context and owner confirmation
 6. **Correlate with downstream service logs** - verify whether any service attempted to use this token and failed silently
 7. **Notify the account owner** for confirmation of legitimate activity before taking any account-level action
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5. Executive Summary

An authentication token issued to test-user-1 at 21:29 UTC on 2026-07-31 has remained unused for 33 minutes, exceeding the organization's 10-minute alert threshold. While this may reflect a benign workflow interruption or test environment behavior, the account name and token age warrant a brief investigation. No compromise is confirmed. Analyst review of the originating request context and account ownership is recommended before any remediation action is taken.

6. Recommended Remediation Controls

- **Token TTL enforcement:** Automatically expire unused tokens after the defined threshold (10 minutes) to reduce the window of potential misuse
- **Alerting refinement:** Tune alerts to differentiate between production and test/service accounts to reduce noise and prioritize higher-risk events
- **Token usage auditing:** Ensure all token issuance and consumption events are logged with IP, user-agent, and service context for complete traceability
- **Least-privilege review:** Confirm test -user -1 has only the permissions required for its intended purpose
- **Service account governance:** Enforce ownership tagging and periodic review of test/service accounts to prevent orphaned credentials
- **Anomaly baselining:** Establish a behavioral baseline for test -user -1 to improve detection of deviations in token generation frequency or timing

Analyst-assistance notice: This report supports human investigation. It does not independently confirm compromise or authorize automated account-disabling actions.